

ASSIGNMENT 1

3 Household items that use child labor :

- 1) **TEA** - Extreme poverty, a lack of access to good schools, and pressure from their families all make children on Sri Lanka's tea estates work. Many had to drop out of school to help their family by working in tea plantations, weighing leaves, or cleaning factories. The study found that 50 males aged 16 to 19 who worked in the tea sector worked long hours (up to seven days a week), earned very little money (many less than \$10 a week, and others just got food), and had risky working conditions.

The survey also discovered that 28% of these juvenile laborers said they had been physically assaulted. Many of them had their wages stolen and were forced to work even when they were unwell. Along with physical abuse, sexual abuse was also common. 28% of children said they had been sexually abused, usually by adults in their own towns or workplaces.

The top reasons these kids left school and went to work were poverty (62%), domestic abuse (52%), and not getting enough help with their schoolwork. Children also said that senior workers had forced them to drink alcohol or use drugs, which shows how exploitative tea farms are in general.

[[Reference](#)]

- 2) **LOCK** - People in Aligarh, Uttar Pradesh, hear metal on metal every day. The city is known for its lock-making business, which sends locks to homes all over India and beyond. But the truth behind this industry is scary: a lot of the people making these locks are kids. In small, informal factories and cramped home workshops, kids as young as nine work long hours filing sharp edges, putting together tiny parts, and polishing metal. Their work is very hard on them because they don't have much light, safety gear, or protection from dust and chemicals. It's common to have eye strain, trouble breathing, cuts, and burns.

Most of these kids come from poor families that can't pay for school. Many have dropped out because they were supposed to help support the family. Parents often think that work will teach their kids useful skills, but it actually takes away their health, education, and a real childhood.

People don't always notice child labor because a lot of it happens in homes and places that aren't regulated. The cycle will keep going as long as there is poverty, weak laws, and a need for cheap goods.

There should be a child behind every lock from Aligarh who is learning, playing, and dreaming, not working in silence.

[[Reference](#)]

- 3) **CARPET** - Child labor is still a big problem in India's carpet industry, especially in the Mirzapur-Bhadohi area of Uttar Pradesh, which makes most of the country's hand-knotted carpets. A 2005 study of 240 loom businesses found that 7.13% of the people who worked there were children, mostly boys under 14. The number was even higher in the more labor-intensive Persian-style carpets, where it reached 9.05%. These kids are doing complicated and repetitive tasks like weaving, knotting, trimming, and handling dyed yarn. They often work 10 to 12 hours a day in dark, poorly ventilated rooms with no proper seating or safety measures. The work environment is very bad for your health because you are always exposed to wool dust and have to sit in uncomfortable positions. 58% of the children work for their families, while the other 42% are hired, including some migrant children from poorer states like Bihar and Jharkhand. A common way to get children to work is through bonded labor, where they have to work off debts their families owe. Child labor is still a problem, even though the Child Labour Act of 1986 made it illegal and there have been efforts by NGOs, government programs like the National Child Labour Project, and international pressure through labeling initiatives (like Rugmark and Kaleen). Children are still being used in production areas that aren't as closely watched or are new, and they are often kept out of sight of the public to avoid legal trouble.

[[Reference](#)]

ASSIGNMENT 2

2 Child Rights that I would like to associate myself with :

- 1) **RIGHT TO SHARE THOUGHTS FREELY** - I want to be a part of the Right to Share Thoughts Freely because every child should feel like they are being heard. Being able to say what you think and feel, whether it's with words, pictures, or even just asking questions, is a big part of growing up with confidence and self-worth. When kids can't speak up because they're scared, ignored, or never taught that their voice matters, they are more likely to be hurt. If they know something is wrong or unfair but don't feel safe saying it, it's much easier for others to take advantage of them. A child shouldn't have to suffer because of silence. Letting kids say what they want to say not only helps them learn, but it also keeps them safe. It says to them, "You are important." What you say is important. And I think every kid should know that.

- 2) **PROTECTION FROM SEXUAL ABUSE** - I want to be a part of the Right to Protection from Sexual Abuse because no child should ever have their innocence taken away. Kids should feel safe, loved, and free to be kids. They shouldn't have to live in fear or carry pain that someone else caused. It hurts to know that kids are hurt in ways they don't fully understand, and that these people are often people they trust. Some kids are put in scary situations or made to do things that no child should ever have to do. And the worst part is that a lot of them don't know how to speak up or are too scared or ashamed to try. That's why this right is so important. You are not to blame for what happened to you, you deserve to be safe, and you are not to blame for what happened to you. They need adults who will listen to them, believe them, and keep them safe. This means more than just following the law; it means caring for them, paying attention to them, and taking action. Keeping kids safe from sexual abuse is more than just keeping them safe. It's about making sure they have the right to grow up whole, to laugh, to learn, and to feel safe in their own skin. I want to stand up for that right because every child's body, heart, and trust should be safe at all costs.

ASSIGNMENT 3

5 issues that CRY has been working on and its Data:

- 1) **SEXUAL ABUSE AND EXPLOITATION** - Sexual assault is one of the most horrible things that can happen to a kid. It takes away their safety, trust, and frequently their voice.

The number of recorded instances under the POCSO Act in India has grown significantly, from about 8,900 in 2014 to more than 53,000 in 2021. More than a third of all crimes against minors are now these kinds of crimes. Many more are probably not reported, especially by males, because they are afraid, ashamed, or afraid of being judged by others. Behind every number is a child who might be too scared to talk and too young to comprehend that what happened to them wasn't their fault.

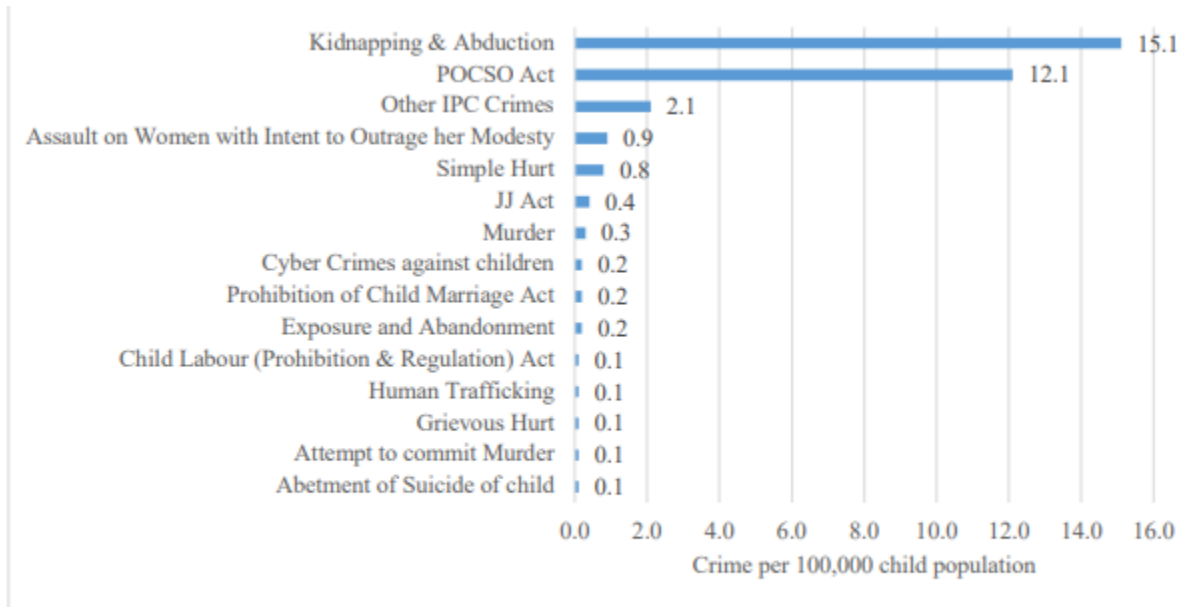


Figure 1: Head-wise crime rates for crimes committed against children in India

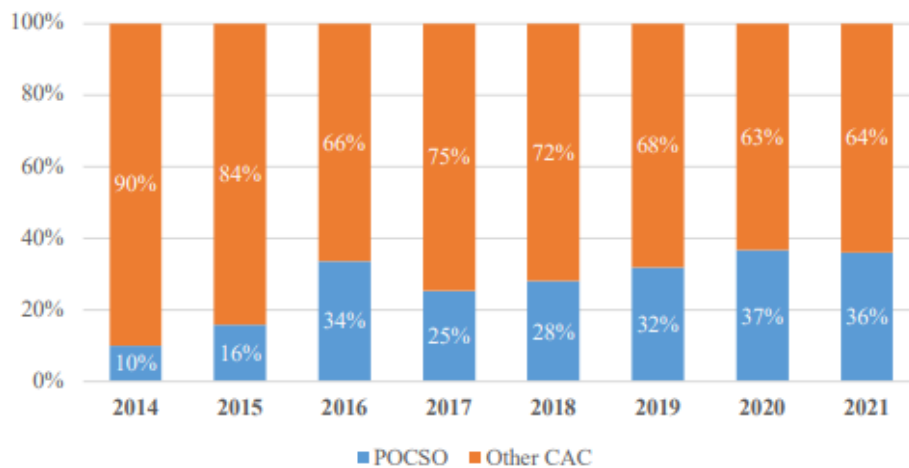


Figure 2: Contribution of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) incidence to all crimes against children in India

Child Rights and You (CRY) works hard to alter this situation. CRY doesn't just step in after abuse occurred; it works at the roots. This is because it believes in protection, dignity, and child-centered care. CRY helps children find safe places where they may speak up and be heard by raising awareness in the community, teaching parents and teachers, setting up child

protection committees, and providing legal aid. It makes sure that survivors are not only saved, but also helped in all three areas of their lives: emotionally, socially, and educationally. This helps them start to heal. CRY's goal is to provide every child not merely the chance to live, but also the chance to grow up feeling secure, seen, and really protected.

[[Reference](#)]

- 2) **CHILD MARRIAGE** - Child marriage is still a sad reality for millions of girls in India. The law states it can't happen, yet it happens a lot nevertheless because of poverty, gender inequality, and cultural norms. A recent research on survival finds that India has the most child brides in the world, even though its marriage rates by age are lower than those in several African countries. This is because India has a lot of people. The risk rises significantly after age 15, with 10% of girls marrying between ages 17 and 18. These early marriages can often preclude a girl from going to school and make her more likely to get pregnant, be abused by her husband, and lose her freedom. A girl who is married is considerably more likely to drop out of school, get sick, and not have much control over her own choices.

Table 3. Comparison of estimates of girls marrying before age 18 in 2020 using direct approach and survival analysis approach, in 17 select countries.

Country	Married before 18, among women age 20–24 (%)	Direct approach	Survival analysis approach	Difference between results (000)	Percentage difference in results (%)	Average annual rate of population change (%) 2015–2020
		Estimated number of girls marrying before age 18 (000)				
Burundi	19	22	8	-14	-62	3.15
Ghana	19	58	34	-24	-41	2.19
Chad	61	108	65	-44	-40	3.04
Nepal	33	106	64	-41	-39	1.51
India	25	2987	1905	-1082	-36	1.04
Philippines	17	166	107	-58	-35	1.41
Yemen	32	98	64	-35	-35	2.37
Ethiopia	40	511	332	-179	-35	2.62
Kenya	23	133	87	-47	-35	2.32
Zambia	29	60	39	-21	-34	2.93
Thailand	20	88	60	-27	-31	0.31
Nigeria	43	902	631	-271	-30	2.59
Bangladesh	51	785	551	-234	-30	1.05
Indonesia	16	371	261	-110	-30	1.14
Tanzania	31	187	189	2	1	2.97
Mozambique	48	167	173	6	3	2.90
South Africa	4	17	18	1	8	1.37

<https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0258378.t003>

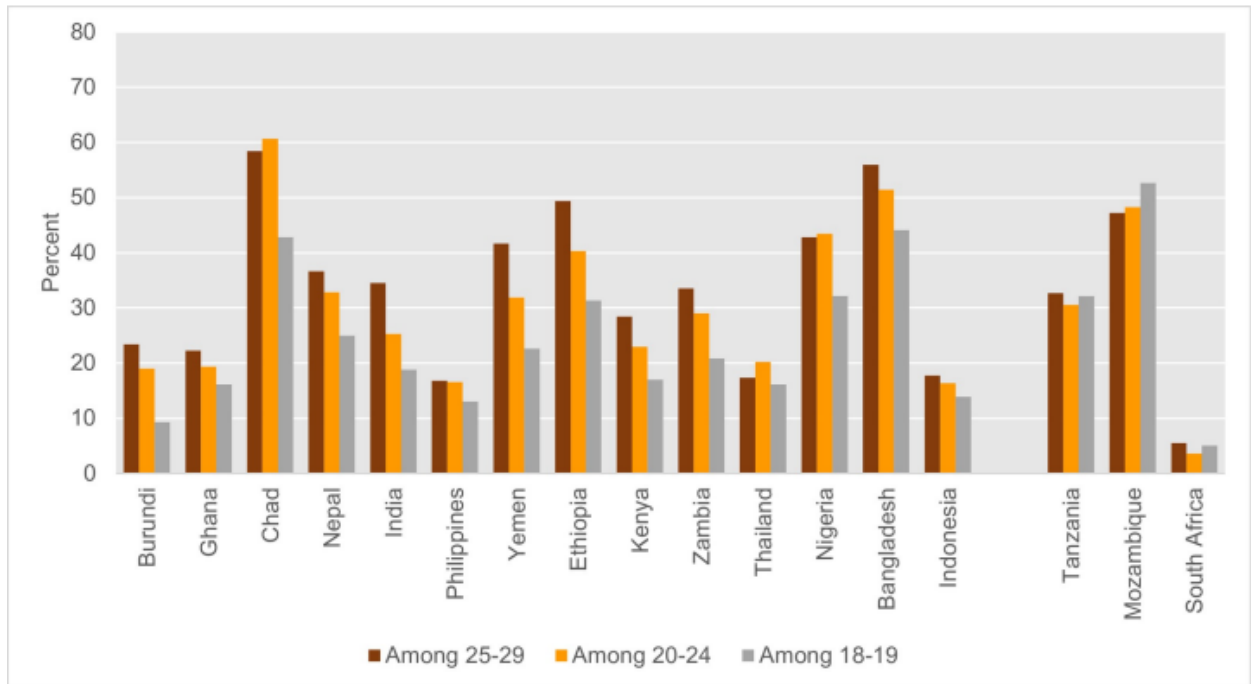


Fig 3. Proportion of women marrying before age 18, among women in age groups 18–19, age 20–24, and age 25–29 years, in select 17 countries.

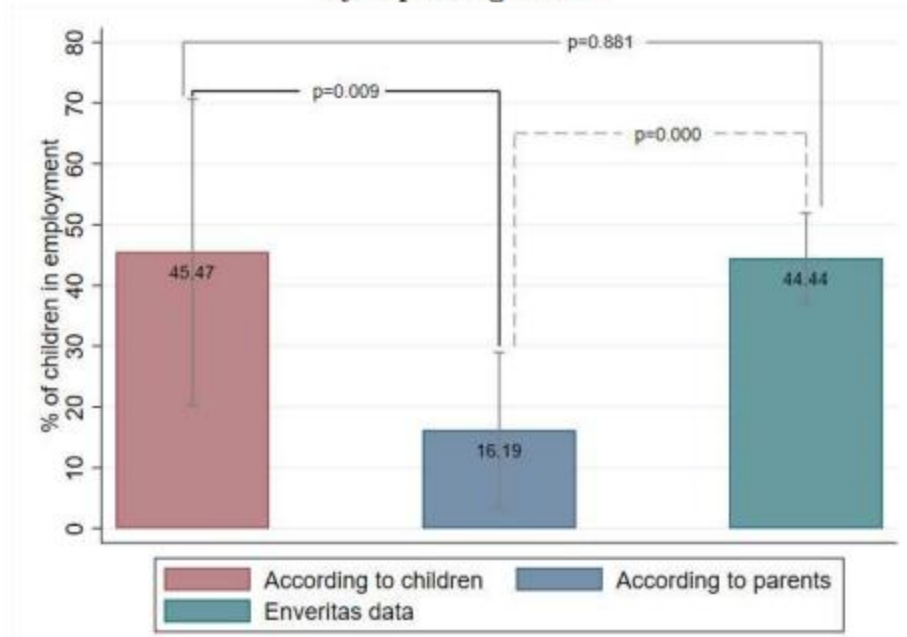
Child Rights and You (CRY) wants to stop this cycle of unfairness. The main goals of CRY are to keep girls in school, train people in their communities about the problem, and work closely with groups that help keep kids safe in their own neighborhoods. They do this by believing in giving people power, gender equality, and the rights of children. CRY says that 99% of the teenage girls in the communities where they work are protected from being married off as children. This shows that their work is making a difference. CRY gives girls safe spaces to dream about things other than being married young by employing youth-led groups like Children's Collectives, teaching them life skills, and making sure that laws are obeyed. They don't just want to halt weddings; they also want to give every girl the chance to grow, learn, and make choices that will change her life.

[[Reference](#)]

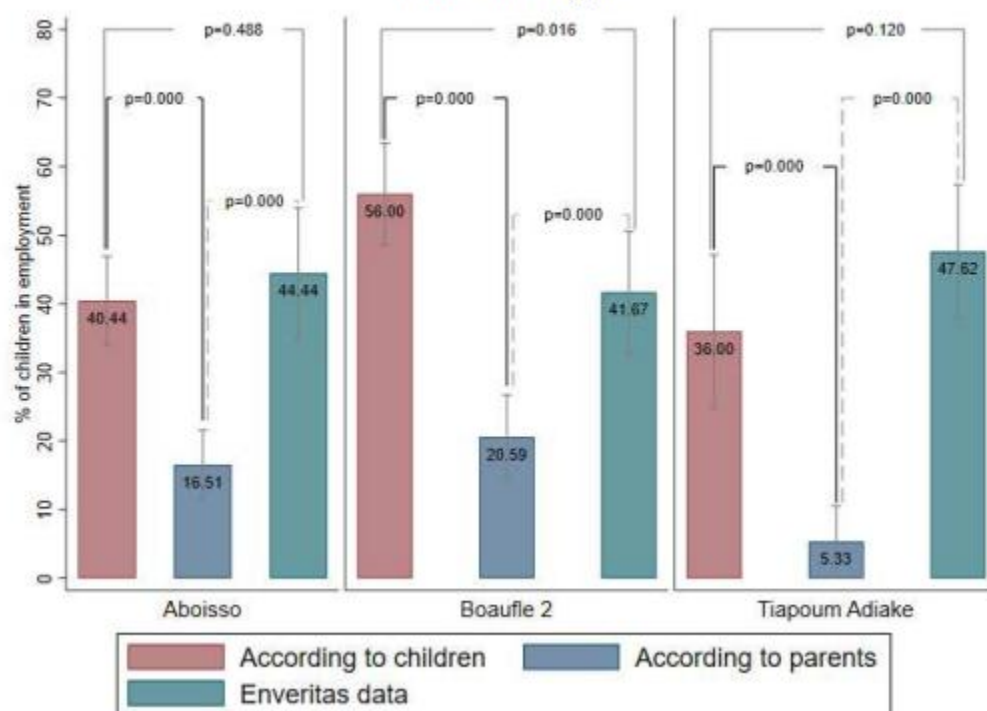
- 3) **CHILD LABOR** - Child labor is still one of the most serious breaches of children's rights in the globe today. The International Labour Organization (ILO) says that there are about 160 million child laborers across the world, but recent study shows that this number may be far lower than it really is. A study from 2022 showed that when kids were asked directly, they stated that the number of youngsters working was up to three times higher than what adults said. This suggests that the real number of youngsters aged 7 to 14 throughout the world might be more than 373 million. In a lot of rural and low-income communities, youngsters as young as five labor in factories, farms, and homes. They often miss school and suffer long-term physical and mental damage. Adjusted calculations show that child labor in India might be more than 20 times higher than what official numbers imply. This is primarily

because people don't report it and do work informally. CRY (Child Rights and You) has been fighting against child labor for a long time. CRY opposes child labor in numerous methods, including grassroots actions, initiatives to assist kids get back to school, family counseling, and campaigning for improved laws. These things are built on the ideals of respect, child-centered development, and the right to an education. The #LearnNotEarn movement argues for every child's right to attend to school instead of having to work. You can see the difference CRY makes in the locations where it works: 88% of youngsters between the ages of 6 and 18 are not working.

Panel A: Share of students who worked in cocoa plantations, by reporting source



Panel B: Share of students who worked in cocoa plantations, by source and region



- 4) **MALNUTRITION** - Malnutrition is still a hidden danger to the futures of millions of Indian kids. The NFHS-5 and other recent studies suggest that 36% of kids under five are stunted, 32% are underweight, and 19% are wasting. That means that nearly one in three children isn't getting the food they need to grow and learn. Not only does malnutrition mean being hungry, but it also means injustice, terrible health for moms, not enough education, and neglect by institutions. Kids in rural areas, especially girls, are damaged more than kids in cities. More than 40% of kids in places like Bihar and Meghalaya are still short. Not obtaining adequate food causes around 45% of child fatalities in India for kids under five.

CRY (Child Rights and You) believes that malnutrition is more than just a health issue; it is also a violation of a child's right to grow up with dignity. CRY works with communities to fix the root causes of health issues in children. For example, they teach mothers, help them receive government nutrition programs, encourage breastfeeding, and make sure that children have regular health checkups. Ninety-two percent of kids under five who live in areas where CRY serves are not malnourished. CRY works with anganwadis and health workers to raise awareness and execute nutrition initiatives to assist children not only survive but also thrive.

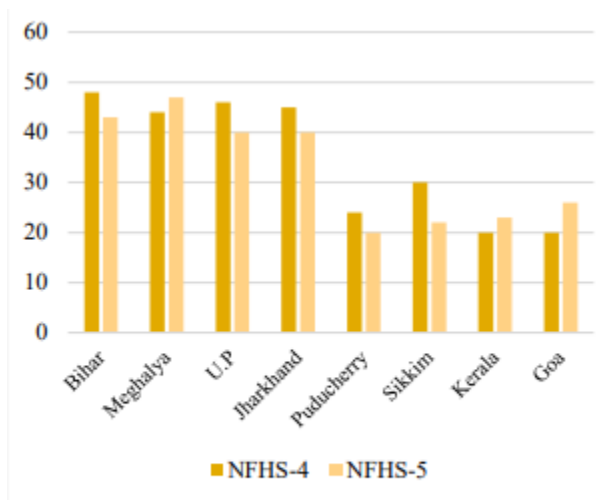


Figure 3: Rate of stunting in some states of India.

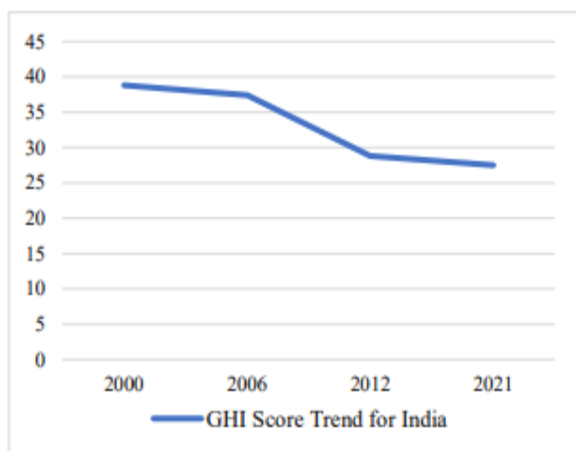


Figure 5: Global Hunger Index Score trend for India from 2000 to 2021.

[[Reference](#)]

- 5) **EDUCATION ACCESS** - Consider a young child in a small village who wishes to learn but whose parents cannot afford or do not care about her early education, and who lives in an area without a preschool. Imagine a happy classroom in a city apartment where a child of the same age is playing with letter blocks and counting games. This difference isn't just a coincidence; it shows how unfair India's early education system is. The government has said it will do something about it, but about 80% of kids aged 3 to 5 still don't go to formal pre-primary school. This is especially true for kids from groups that have been historically disadvantaged, like Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, and families with low incomes. These kids are missing more than just ABCs and 123s; they're missing the basic things that will help them learn for the rest of their lives, like confidence, curiosity, and connection. We at CRY—Kid Rights and You believe that every child should have that spark, regardless of their place of birth or surname. Education is not just a right; it's a way to stay alive. That's why we work in places that don't have enough resources. We help parents understand how important preschool is, we strengthen Anganwadi centers, and we make sure that no child is left out of statistics or policies. We want a future where no child has to miss school because their mother never went to school or because there are no buses in their area. When we level the playing field in the first few years, we give kids not only an education but also a chance to dream and the tools to make those dreams come true.

Table 1 Share of children aged 3–5 years attending pre-primary, primary or no schools

Age	Pre-primary grade (nursery/kindergarten)	Primary grade	Out of formal school	Total
3 year	8.3	0.1	91.6	100 (6667)
4 year	25.5	1.4	73.1	100 (6904)
5 year	26.7	36.2	37.1	100 (6391)
Total (3–5 years)	20.2	11.9	67.9	100 (19,962)

Figures in parentheses in the last column show the absolute number of students

Source: Authors' estimation from 75th NSO round data, 2017–2018

Table 3 Percentage of population attending pre-primary education in India by age and socioeconomic characteristics

	3 years	4 years	5 years	Total (3–5 years)
Gender				
Female	8.5	24.1	24.8	19.0
Male	8.0	26.8	28.3	21.2
Caste				
ST	4.8	18.0	16.5	13.1
SC	7.4	20.8	24.1	17.3
OBC	7.0	24.2	24.5	18.7
General	13.2	36.8	38.7	29.4
Religion				
Hindu	8.4	25.6	26.0	20.0
Muslim	6.5	20.0	24.6	16.9
Others	12.9	47.2	48.3	35.9
Residence				
Rural	6.0	20.5	20.6	15.7
Urban	15.6	43.1	43.8	34.3
Consumption quintile				
Q1 (poorest)	3.2	13.1	16.0	10.8
Q2	7.2	18.2	21.1	15.5
Q3	7.5	27.9	26.4	20.4
Q4	11.5	36.5	35.3	27.8
Q5 (richest)	19.5	54.4	49.8	41.5
Household head's education status				
Illiterate	4.3	16.2	16.8	12.4
Elementary	8.5	24.2	26.3	19.6
Secondary	9.4	34.8	38.0	27.5
Grad and above	21.9	48.6	43.9	38.1
Total	8.3	25.5	26.7	20.1

Authors' estimation from 75th NSO round data, 2017–2018

[[Reference](#)]

ISSUE	DATA POINT	CRY's Response
Child Labour	6,000+ cases (NCRB 2022)	#LearnNotEarn campaign, rescue & reintegration
Child Marriage	23.3% girls married before 18 (NFHS-5)	CARC program, 99% protection in CRY areas
Sexual Abuse	56,000+ POCSO cases; 2 cases/hour (NCRB 2022)	Legal aid, community vigilance, protection work
Malnutrition	35.5% under-5s stunted nationally (NFHS-5)	Nutrition, immunization, maternal health programs
Education Access	High dropout after primary (NFHS)	94% school enrollment in CRY project areas